

career objectives different earlier on?

Well, I couldn't tell you what my career ambitions were as an undergraduate, but I didn't necessarily think I was taking the option of a finance career off the table by majoring in history. I'm very lucky to have the father I do. He always encouraged me to follow my own path. He is a great role model. He's one of those rare people who can be wildly successful in his career and remain very down to earth. He is the most clear-headed thinker I know, and if I've inherited one trait from him that has helped me as an investor, it's an ability to see things in straightforward, practical terms. You might say we are both good at identifying the obvious. As for my career path, when I decided I was ready to buckle down, my father nudged me toward accounting as a backdoor way to get into private equity. It's a better background for private equity than the traditional career paths of investment banking or management consulting. There is truth in the adage that accounting is the language of business.

Did you go back to school for an accounting degree?

Yes. At the time, NYU had a special master's of accounting program that was sponsored by the "Big Six" accounting firms who wanted to diversify their staff pool to include undergrads with liberal arts degrees. In fact, one of the prerequisites to be hired into the program was that you hadn't taken any prior accounting courses. There was a summer crash course to cover four years of accounting classes, and then you were thrown into the financial audit group as a first year staff accountant. I was hired by Ernst & Young, LLP and worked primarily on audits of large investment banks.

Did you go into private equity after you finished your degree?

Yes. I went to work for Golub Capital, which was then a small private equity firm—Charlie Ledley was its first ever investment analyst, and I was the second—but has now grown its assets under management from less than \$100 million to several billion dollars.

What did you learn there that was useful to you later on?